

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	CHC234P
Subject Title	Modern and Contemporary Chinese Literature 中國現當代文學
Credit Value	3
Level	2
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	Nil
Objectives	This course offers an in-depth exploration of major literary movements, representative writers, and landmark works in Chinese literature from the May Fourth period to the early twenty-first century. It situates modern and contemporary Chinese literature within the broader framework of world literature and examines it through the lens of Sinophone studies. The course engages with writings from Republican-era China and, following the 1949 bifurcation, from mainland China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, and Malaysia. Emphasizing both literary and cultural analysis, the course aims to develop students' capacity to interpret texts within their historical and intellectual contexts. It further encourages critical reflection on the relationship between literature and history while cultivating essential academic writing and research skills for scholarly inquiry. 本課程講授五四以降至二十一世紀初期中國文學中的重要文學現象和代表作家及作品。同時，這門課將中國現當代文學置於「世界文學」的語境之中，同時，在「華語文學」的範疇內同時考察民國時期、1949 年大分野之後的中國內地、香港、台灣、以及馬來西亞的華文作品。課程主旨是講授怎樣用進行文學與文化分析的能力，啟發同學思考文學之於歷史研究的意義，同時亦注重培養學生在學術論文寫作方面的能力。
Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 1)</i>	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) comprehend the close relationship between these masterpieces and modern Chinese history and culture as well as the way how they responded to and participated to the trend of a particular historical period; b) obtain multiple perspectives on the richness and uniqueness of modern Chinese literature

	c) master the skills to analyse a series of literary works d) demonstrate a critical thinking ability to understand literary texts																																				
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus <i>(Note 2)</i>	1) Modern Chinese Literature as Part of World literature 2) Ways of Reading Lu Xun: Close Reading and Chinese Literary Modernity 3) Urban Modernity (I): Flaneur and Writings about Shanghai 4) Urban Modernity (II): The Rise of Modern Chinese Woman Writers and Their Writings about the City 5) How to Imagine the Nation: Mass Media and Rural China 6) Diaspora in the Sinophone World: Taiwan and Overseas Chinese Writers 7) Diaspora in the Sinophone World: Hong Kong 8) Diaspora in the Sinophone World: Malaysia 9) Writing an Academic Paper and Bei Dao and World Poetry 10) The Rise of Middle Class and Self-help Culture: Workplace Novels 11) Post-human Temporal and Spatial Construct: China's science fiction																																				
Teaching/Learning Methodology <i>(Note 3)</i>	This course will include lectures, classroom discussions, group oral presentations as well as final paper writing. Before the class, students should complete the assigned readings, watch the films/plays, listen to the musical pieces and write down their thoughts and questions to be raised during class discussions. Lectures will provide key concepts, themes and historical/social contexts and demonstrate the ways of analyzing the texts. Moreover, the course materials are interdisciplinary and multimedia in nature and therefore, the course will provide the students with diverse experience through listening, watching, and reading and then further train the students' ability of critical thinking. Students are encouraged to find materials related to that week's subject and readings independently and share with the other students their findings, thoughts, analysis and raise questions during their oral presentations. They will have opportunities to exercise their critical thinking and voice their opinions during the tutorials. and their presentations will further diversity the students' understandings and enrich the course content as a whole.																																				
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes <i>(Note 4)</i>	<table border="1"> <thead> <tr> <th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="6">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr> <tr> <th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th><th></th><th></th></tr> </thead> <tbody> <tr> <td>1. Final exam</td><td>10 %</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr> <tr> <td>2. In-class assessment and Oral Presentation</td><td>30% (10%+20%)</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td></td></tr> </tbody> </table>							Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)						a	b	c	d			1. Final exam	10 %	✓	✓	✓	✓			2. In-class assessment and Oral Presentation	30% (10%+20%)	✓	✓	✓	✓		
Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)																																			
		a	b	c	d																																
1. Final exam	10 %	✓	✓	✓	✓																																
2. In-class assessment and Oral Presentation	30% (10%+20%)	✓	✓	✓	✓																																

	3. Readings	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓		
	4. Final Papers	50%	✓	✓	✓	✓		
	Total	100 %						
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: The assessment combines reading notes with in-class presentation and participation to deepen engagement with modern Chinese literature. Reading notes ensure careful, independent analysis of assigned texts, while presentations and participation promote critical discussion, interpretive skills, and collaborative learning. Together, these components encourage both individual reflection and active contribution to the intellectual community of the class. The Final exam will test students’ grasp of their knowledge of the content of the subject. Oral presentations will test the students’ ability to find materials independently and their skills of articulating their thoughts and analyzing the materials. A term paper will test the students’ ability to incorporate what they learn from the class and their analytical skills into the written assignments. The students will be also required to submit reading notes twice during the course (between 300 and 500 words). This will facilitate active reading, thinking and writing throughout the entire semester. Final paper requirement: Write a 4-5-page paper on a topic of your choice and in consultation with the instructor. Manuscripts must be double-spaced with 12-point type and 1inch margins and formatted for letter-size (8.5 x 11 in.) paper if possible. (or approximately 1600 words) .Your paper needs to discuss at least one primary text or film from the course while engaging relevant critical issues. Your paper must be word-processed, double-spaced, page-numbered, and spell-checked. It should have normal margins and a readable font. The quotation style follows Chicago style. You should always back up your argument with evidence from the texts through judicious use of quotations and paraphrases (keep plot summaries to a minimum and avoid lengthy quotations). You are expected to make use of the scholarly texts from the course to the best of your ability. In addition, please also include 2-3 scholarly articles to support your analysis and argument. The reading list has been updated and is closely related to the subjects of the course. Many recent publications have been included.							
	Class contact:							
	▪ Lectures						26 Hrs.	

Student Study Effort Expected	▪ Tutorials	13 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:	
	▪ Readings	48 Hrs.
	▪ Writing Report	33 Hrs.
	Total student study effort	120 Hrs.
Reading List and References	Reading List Primary Literary Texts and Films Hu Shi 胡適. “Zhongsheng Dashi 終身大事” and “Wenxue Gailiang Chuyi 文學改良芻議.” In <i>Hu Shi Wencun 胡適文存</i>. Beijing: Zhonghua Shuju, 1998. Lu Xun 魯迅. “Kuangren Riji 狂人日記” and “Preface to Call to Arms 〈吶喊自序〉.” In <i>Lu Xun QuANJI 魯迅全集</i>, Vol. 1. Beijing: Renmin Wenxue Chubanshe, 2005. (Originally published in 1921.) Mao Dun 茅盾. <i>Ziye 子夜</i>. Beijing: Renmin Wenxue Chubanshe, 1962. (Originally published in 1933.) Shi Zhecun 施蛰存. “Meiyu zhi Xi 梅雨之夕.” In <i>Shi Zhecun Wenji 施蛰存文集</i>, Vol. 1. Shanghai: Shanghai Wenyi Chubanshe, 1991. (Originally published in 1931.) Ding Ling 丁玲. “Yijiu Sanling Nian Chun Shanghai 一九三零年春上海.” In <i>Ding Ling Wenji 丁玲文集</i>. Beijing: Renmin Wenxue Chubanshe, 1982. (Originally published in 1930.) Zhang Ailing 張愛玲. <i>Qingcheng zhi Lian 傾城之戀</i>. Taipei: Crown Publishing 皇冠出版社, 1979. (Originally published in 1943.) Lu Xun 魯迅. “Guxiang 故鄉.” In <i>Lu Xun QuANJI 魯迅全集</i>, Vol. 1. Beijing: Renmin Wenxue Chubanshe, 2005. (Originally published in 1921.) Bai Xianyong 白先勇. “Yongyuan de Yin Xueyan 永遠的尹雪艷” and “Youyuan Jingmeng 游園驚夢.” In <i>Taibeiren 台北人</i>. Taipei: Crown Publishing 皇冠出版社, 1971. Liu Yichang 劉以鬯. <i>Duidao 對倒</i>. Hong Kong: Mingbao Chubanshe 明報出版社, 1979.	

	Huang Jinshu 黃錦樹. “Sizai Nanfang 死在南方” and “Yuhai 魚骸.” In <i>Yu 雨</i>. Kuala Lumpur: Dajiang Chubanshe 大將出版社, 1997. Huang Deng 黃燈. <i>Wo de Erben Xuesheng 我的二本學生</i>. Beijing: Beijing Shiyue Wenyi Chubanshe, 2017. Yu, Dafu 郁達夫. 1921. <i>Chenlun 沉淪</i>. Shanghai: Shangwu Yinshuguan 商務印書館. Shen, Congwen 沈從文. 1929. <i>Xiaoxiao 蕭蕭</i>. Shanghai: Taidong Shuju 泰東書局. Xi, Xi 西西. 1986. <i>Fucheng 浮城</i>. Hong Kong: Suye Wenxue She 素葉文學社. Film: <i>Wu Duo Jinhua 五朵金花</i>. Directed by Wang Jiayi 王家乙. Changchun Film Studio 長春電影製片廠, 1959. Secondary Readings (Critical and Theoretical Works) Wang, David Der-wei 王德威. “‘Shijie Zhong’ de Zhongguo Wenxue 「世界中」的中國文學.” In <i>Harvard Xinbian Zhongguo Xiandai Wenxueshi 哈佛新編中國現代文學史</i>. Edited by Wang Dewei. Taipei: Lianjing Chubanshe, 2021. Cheng, Guangwei 程光燁. “Xiangxuemen de ‘1980 niandai’——Cong xiaoshuo ‘O, Xiangxue’ he wenxue piping zhong zheshe de dangshi nongcun zhi yi jiao 香雪們的‘1980 年代’——從小說《哦，香雪》和文學批評中折射的當時農村之一角.” <i>Wenxue Bao 文學報</i>, 2021. [Online] Miner, Blake. “What Is a Flâneur? An Evolving Guide to the Meaning and Philosophy.” <i>Flâneur Life</i>, October 31, 2024. https://www.flaneurlife.com/flaneur-meaning/. White Heyden. 海登 懷特《作為文學虛構的歷史本文》(The Historical Text as Literary Artifact) 選自《新歷史主義與文學批評》張京媛主編，北京大學出版社，1993，160-179. Zhang, Ling 張玲. “Xingbie, Minzu yu Shehuizhuyi Xiandaixing: <Wu Duo Jinhua> zhong de Lütu Xushi yu Gonglu Xingtai 性別、民族與社會主義現代性：《五朵金花》中的旅途敘事與公路形態.” <i>Dianying Yishu 電影藝術</i> 3 (2020): 88–99. Reference on General Studies 1. 洪子誠：《中國當代文學史》，北京：北京大學出版社，
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	2007. 2. 錢理群、溫儒敏、吳福輝著:《中國現代文學三十年(修訂本)》。北京:北京大學出版社,1998年。 3. 夏志清:《中國現代小說史》,香港:香港中文大學出版社,2001. 4. 楊義:《中國現代小說史》。北京:人民文學出版社,1993年。 5. 趙家璧主編:《中國新文學大系 1918-1927》(第1-8卷,導言,胡適、鄭振鐸、茅盾、鄭伯奇、魯迅、周作人、郁達夫、朱自清著)。上海:良友圖書公司出版,1935-1936年。 6. Carlos Rojas and Andrea Bachner eds. <i>The Oxford Handbook of Modern Chinese Literatures</i>. New York: Oxford University Press, 2016. 7. Denton, Kirk ed. <i>The Columbia Companion to Modern Chinese Literature</i>. New York: Columbia University Press, 2016. 8. Wang, David Der-wei. "Chinese Literature from 1841 to 1937" in Chang Kang-i Sun and Stephen Owen eds., <i>The Cambridge History of Chinese Literature</i> (Volume II). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010. 9. Wang, David Der-wei ed. <i>A New Literary History of Modern China</i>. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2017. Part II. Reference on the Studies of Individual Authors and Literary Works 1. 陳平原:《中國小說敘事模式的轉變》。北京:北京大學出版社,2010。 2. 賀桂梅:《趙樹理文學與鄉土中國現代性》,太原:北嶽文藝出版社,2016。 3. 金介甫:《沈從文傳》,北京:國際文化出版公司,2009. 4. 李海燕:《心靈革命:現代中國的愛情譜系》,北京:北京大學出版社,2018. 5. 李歐梵:《上海摩登——一種新都市文化在中國,1930-1945》,北京:北京大學出版社,2001. 6. 李歐梵:《鐵屋中的吶喊》,杭州:浙江大學出版社,2016. 7. 李歐梵:《蒼涼與世故:張愛玲的啟示》。香港:牛津大學出版社,2006。 8. 凌宇:《從邊城走向世界:對作為文學家的沈從文的研
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- 究》。北京：三聯書店，1985。
9. 劉禾：《語際書寫：現代思想史寫作批評綱要》，上海：上海三聯書店，1999.
 10. 劉禾：《跨語際實踐：文學、民族文化與被譯介的現代性(中國 1900-1937)》，北京：生活·讀書·新知三聯書店，2008。
 11. 孟悅、戴錦華：《浮出歷史地表：中國現代女性文學研究》。臺北：時報文化出版公司，1993。
 12. 歐陽子：《王謝堂前的燕子——白先勇《臺北人》的研析與索隱》，桂林：廣西師範大學出版社，2014.
 13. 錢理群、黃子平、陳平原著：《二十世紀中國文學三人談·漫說文化》。北京：北京大學出版，2004。
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 15. 王斑：《歷史與記憶——全球現代性的質疑》，香港：牛津大學出版社，2004.
 16. 王德威：《茅盾、老舍、沈從文：寫實主義與現代中國小說》。臺北：麥田出版，2009。
 17. 王潤華：《沈從文小說新論》。臺北：文史哲出版社，1998。
 18. 王曉明主編：《二十世紀中國文學史論》。上海：東方，1997。
 19. 吳福輝：《都市漩流中的海派小說》。長沙：湖南教育出版社，1995。
 20. 楊小濱：《中國後現代：先鋒小說中的精神創傷與反諷》。上海：上海三聯書店，2013。
 21. 趙毅衡：《苦惱的敘述者》，北京：北京十月文藝出版社，1994.
 22. Chow, Rey. *Woman and Chinese Modernity: The Politics of Reading between West and East*. Minneapolis, MN: University of Minnesota Press, 1991.
 23. Lee, Leo Ou-fan. *Voices from the Iron House: A Study of Lu Xun*. Bloomington & Indianapolis: Indiana University Press, 1987.
 24. Goldman, Merle (ed.). *Modern Chinese Literature in the May Fourth Era*. Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1977.
 25. Kong, Shuying. *Consuming Literature: Bestsellers and the Commercialization of Literary Production in Contemporary*

	<i>China</i>, Stanford, CA: Stanford University Press, 2004. 26. Larson, Wendy. <i>Women and Writing in Modern China</i>. Stanford: Stanford University Press, 1998. 27. Liu, Lydia H. <i>Translingual Practice: Literature, National Culture, and Translated Modernity--China, 1900-1937</i>. Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 1995. 28. McDougall, Bonnie S. <i>Mao Zedong's "Talks at the Yan'an Conference on Literature and Art": A Translation of the 1943 Text with Commentary</i>. Ann Arbor: Center for Chinese Studies, University of Michigan Press, 1980. 29. Shih, Shu-mei. <i>The Lure of the Modern: Writing Modernism in Semi-Colonial China</i>. Los Angeles and Berkeley: University of California Press, 2001. 30. Song, Mingwei and Theodore Hutters eds. <i>The Reincarnated Giant, Chinese Science Fiction in the Twenty-First Century: Taiwan, Hong Kong, and the PRC</i>. New York: Columbia University Press, 2018. 31. Tang, Xiaobing. <i>Chinese Modern: The Heroic and the Quotidian</i>, Durham & London: Duke University Press, 2000. 32. Wang, Ban. <i>The Sublime Figure of History: Aesthetics and Politics in Twentieth-Century China</i>, Stanford, CA: Stanford University Press, 1997.
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Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon subject completion. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time, overcrowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method is intended to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.

(Form AR 140) 8.2020